

Contributing to The Office

SECTION 01-governance

TYPE document

STATUS **active**

OWNER Founder

UPDATED 2026-08-19

This guide is for **this repository** — `ay2m/Office`, the internal documents repo. (The application repos have their own contributing guides; setup steps and `npm run check:*` commands for the web app do **not** apply here.)

Start with the root `CLAUDE.md` — it is the source of truth for this repo's structure and conventions. This file is the short operational companion to it.

What a contribution looks like here

There is no application code in this repo. A change is almost always one of:

- **Drafting or editing a document** — a policy, contract draft, playbook, spec, or runbook (`.md`).
- **Updating a deliverable** — a `.docx` / `.xlsx` / `.pptx` produced offline and committed as a binary.
- **Reorganizing** — renaming, moving, or re-indexing files (update `_INDEX.md` and, if the Arabic mirror is affected, `ar/` in the same change).

Conventions that are load-bearing

- **Not affiliated with GACA.** Fly GACA is an independent educational platform. Never imply official GACA status in any document, and never fabricate a regulatory citation — link or name the official GACA source instead.
- **Front-matter on every** `.md`. Every content Markdown file carries the standard YAML block (`title` / `section` / `doc_type` / `status` / `owner` / `last_updated` / `lang`). Files under any `templates/` directory need only a `title` key. The root `README.md` is exempt from the front-matter check only.
- **Rebuild the PDF with every** `.md` **edit.** Each `.md` has a print-ready PDF under `_print/`. Regenerate before committing:

```
cd tools/print
npm ci          # once, or after a dependency change
npm run build   # incremental — only changed docs re-render
```

Commit the regenerated PDF and the updated `tools/print/.buildcache.json` **together with** the `.md` change. HTML pages render separately via `node build-html.mjs`.

- **Bilingual discipline.** New or materially changed content docs should eventually get an `ar/` counterpart at the same path, translated per `ar/_GLOSSARY.md`. CI does not hard-gate EN/AR parity, but don't let the mirror drift silently.

- **Sensitive content.** Legal, financial, HR, and investor documents here are real operating material. Quote or restate the minimum necessary in commit messages, PR descriptions, and external tools.
- **Naming.** Filenames are lowercase ASCII kebab-case, including under `ar/`. Dates in filenames use `YYYY-MM-DD`. See the naming convention in `06-operations-it/repo-health-report-2026-06-16.md` §6.

Before you open a PR

The pre-PR gate for this repo is the docs checker — the same thing CI runs (`.github/workflows/docs-check.yml`):

```
cd tools/print
node check.mjs      # front-matter + Markdown↔PDF coverage + staleness + HTML↔PDF coverage
```

It exits non-zero on any violation. No browser is needed for the check itself.

Pull requests

- Keep changes focused; describe what changed and why.
- All CI checks must be green.
- By contributing, you agree your contributions are licensed under the [Apache License 2.0](#). Regulatory **content** quoted anywhere belongs to GACA and is not covered by that license.

Reporting issues

For anything that could be a security or data-isolation concern — a leaked secret, an over-broad share link, a document that should not have been committed — do **not** open a public issue. Email the maintainer privately at ay2m@hotmail.com (see `SECURITY.md`).